

Meeting Notes

- Jamie drafts FAQ by Friday
- Priya reviews Monday
- Pricing page postponed until legal review
- Legal review owner: Not stated
- Next check-in Tuesday

Recap Prompt Template

Use the following meeting notes to create a weekly recap: {Meeting_Notes}

Decisions

- _____
- _____

Actions (Task | Owner | Due date)

- _____ | _____ | _____
- _____ | _____ | _____

Open Questions

- _____
- _____

What problem are we solving?

Learn how to turn a weekly task into a reusable AI template: fix the output sections, add a rule for missing information, and reuse the same template by changing only the input.

THE SITUATION

The problem

Rina leads a small website team. Every week, someone spends about 30 minutes writing the meeting recap from scratch, and the recaps look different each time. Her root problem is that tasks get lost: last month, two tasks were missed because no one was named as the owner. Her idea is to let ChatGPT write the recap. She pasted the notes and asked, "Summarize these meeting notes." The summary was smooth, but it said, "Priya will handle the legal review by Friday." The notes do not name anyone for the legal review. The summary also left out the decision to postpone the pricing page. The AI filled gaps and dropped a decision because the prompt gave it no format and no rule for missing information.

Today's goal and a three-step method

Learn how to turn a weekly task into a reusable AI template: fix the output sections, add a rule for missing information, and reuse the same template by changing only the input.

STEP 1

Fix the output

Decide the same sections for every week, such as Decisions, Actions, Open questions, and Next meeting.

STEP 2

Add a rule for missing information

Tell the AI to write "Not stated" when an owner or a date is not in the notes.

STEP 3

Reuse and check

Save the prompt as a template with a placeholder. Each week, change only the notes and check the output against them.

Meeting notes, Week 1

Fictional data created for this class. File: data/session_4_1_meeting_notes.csv

CASE FACTS

Meeting notes, Week 1

- "Website FAQ update: Jamie drafts by Friday. Priya reviews Monday. Team agreed to postpone the pricing page until legal review. No owner named for legal review. Next check-in Tuesday."

Time spent on recaps

Fictional data created for this class. File: data/session_4_1_meeting_notes.csv

CASE FACTS

Time spent on recaps

- Writing a recap from scratch: about 30 minutes a week.
- Checking a template recap against the notes: about 5 minutes a week.

Five workflow words you need first

Before you build a reusable prompt, you must know these words. Each example uses Rina's weekly recap.

KEY IDEA

Recurring task

Work that happens again and again in the same way. Example: the weekly meeting recap.

KEY IDEA

Template

A prompt you save and reuse. Only one part changes each time: the input.

KEY IDEA

Placeholder

A marked spot in the template where the new input goes. Example: {Meeting_Notes}.

Five workflow words you need first (continued)

Before you build a reusable prompt, you must know these words. Each example uses Rina's weekly recap.

KEY IDEA

Output format

The fixed sections the answer must have. Example: Decisions; Actions (Task, Owner, Due date); Open questions; Next meeting.

KEY IDEA

"Not stated" rule

An instruction for missing information. If the notes do not name an owner, the AI writes "Not stated" instead of guessing.

Why the AI summary was wrong

"Reads well" and "matches the notes" are different questions. Compare the AI summary with the notes.

AI summary said	The notes say	Problem
"Priya will handle the legal review by Friday."	No owner named for legal review	Invented owner and date
(nothing)	Postpone the pricing page until legal review	Decision left out
"The meeting went well, and the team is aligned."	(nothing)	Filler that is not in the notes

KEY POINTS

What the table shows

- A wrong owner is worse than no owner: Priya may never know she was "assigned," and the task is lost again.
- Saving time: writing from scratch takes 30 minutes a week, and checking a template recap takes about 5. That saves 25 minutes a week, or about 100 minutes in four weeks.

How the three-step method fixes the recap

The instructor runs Poor Prompt 1 and Improved Prompts 1 and 2 below in front of the class and compares the answers.

KEY IDEA

Step 1 fixes the missing-decision problem

A fixed Decisions section makes the AI look for decisions every week.

KEY IDEA

Step 2 fixes the invented-owner problem

The "Not stated" rule turns a gap into a visible open question.

KEY IDEA

Step 3 fixes the start-from-scratch problem

The same template every week gives the same format, and the team only needs to check it.

Poor prompt 1

Same case. Compare what the prompt asks for.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Summarize these meeting notes:
Website FAQ update: Jamie drafts by Friday. Priya reviews Monday. Team agreed to
postpone the pricing page until legal review. No owner named for legal review.
Next check-in Tuesday.

Message AI...

WHAT THE AI OFTEN ANSWERS

A typical result

A smooth paragraph that says "Priya will handle the legal review by Friday," does not mention the pricing page, and adds "The meeting went well."

WHY IT IS WEAK

Reasons

- It gives no output sections, so the AI chooses what to include and can drop a decision.
- It gives no rule for missing information, so the AI fills the missing owner with a guess.
- The format changes every week, so the team still has to read every recap carefully.

Poor prompt 2

Same case. Compare what the prompt asks for.

POOR PROMPT 2 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Write a professional recap of these notes. Assign an owner and a deadline
to every task so nothing is missed:
Website FAQ update: Jamie drafts by Friday. Priya reviews Monday. Team agreed to
postpone the pricing page until legal review. No owner named for legal review.
Next check-in Tuesday.

Message AI...

WHAT THE AI OFTEN ANSWERS

A typical result

A recap in which every task has an owner and a date, including "Legal review: Jamie, by Wednesday."

WHY IT IS WEAK

Reasons

- "Assign an owner to every task" tells the AI to invent owners the team never chose.
- It hides the real problem: the team has not decided who owns the legal review.
- It is still a one-time prompt, not a template the team can reuse.

Improved prompt 1

Steps 1 and 2. Copy this prompt exactly.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

You turn meeting notes into a weekly recap. Use only the notes below.
Write exactly these four sections:
1. Decisions
2. Actions, as a table with the columns Task | Owner | Due date
3. Open questions
4. Next meeting
If an owner or a date is not in the notes, write "Not stated."
Do not add anything that is not in the notes.

Notes:
Website FAQ update: Jamie drafts by Friday. Priya reviews Monday. Team agreed to postpone the pricing page until legal review. No owner named for legal review.
Next check-in Tuesday.

Message AI...

Why it works: improved prompt 1

Each part of the prompt matters.

WHY IT WORKS

Reasons

- The four fixed sections make the AI look for decisions, actions, and questions every time.
- The Task | Owner | Due date table shows at once which tasks have no owner.
- "Not stated" stops the invented owner from Poor Prompts 1 and 2.
- "Do not add anything" removes filler such as "the meeting went well."
- "Use only the notes" keeps the recap faithful to what the team said.

Improved prompt 2

Same case. Compare what the prompt asks for.

IMPROVED PROMPT 2 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Your recap is correct. Now turn my prompt into a reusable template.
Keep all the instructions exactly the same.
Replace the notes with the placeholder {Meeting_Notes}.
Show the full template in one block so I can copy it and save it.

Message AI...

WHY IT WORKS

Reasons

- It saves the prompt that already produced a correct recap.
- "Keep all the instructions exactly the same" stops the AI from changing the rules.
- The placeholder shows exactly where next week's notes go.
- One block is easy to copy into a shared document for the whole team.

Exercise 1: Build the template

Guided practice. Follow the steps in order.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Steps

1. Open ChatGPT and start a **new chat**. Copy Poor Prompt 1 from the box above, paste it, and send it. Write down any owner or date in the summary that is not in the notes, and any decision that is missing. You will need them for your report.
2. Start another **new chat**, so the first answer does not affect the second. Copy Improved Prompt 1, paste it, and send it.
3. Compare the recap with the notes and with the answer key below. Check that the legal review says "Not stated" and that the pricing page decision is included.
4. In the same chat, copy Improved Prompt 2, paste it, and send it. Save the template the AI gives you in a document.
5. For the Results section of your report, write the errors from Step 1 and the recap from Step 3.

Answer key

Use this table to check the AI.

Section	Correct content
Decisions	Postpone the pricing page until the legal review is done.
Actions	Draft the FAQ: Jamie, Friday. Review the FAQ: Priya, Monday. Legal review: Not stated, Not stated.
Open questions	Who owns the legal review, and when will it be done?
Next meeting	Tuesday

Exercise 2: Reuse the template

Applied practice with a template.

HOW IT WORKS

Read first

- The template is only useful if it works every week. Use the template you saved in Exercise 1. Replace {Meeting_Notes} with the new notes and change nothing else.

TEMPLATE - FILL IN, THEN SEND

AI Chat

You

You turn meeting notes into a weekly recap. Use only the notes below.
Write exactly these four sections:
1. Decisions
2. Actions, as a table with the columns Task | Owner | Due date
3. Open questions
4. Next meeting
If an owner or a date is not in the notes, write "Not stated."
Do not add anything that is not in the notes.

Notes:
{Meeting_Notes}

Message AI...

Part A: Worked example (run it)

Copy and send this completed prompt in the same chat.

PART A - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

You turn meeting notes into a weekly recap. Use only the notes below.
Write exactly these four sections:
1. Decisions
2. Actions, as a table with the columns Task | Owner | Due date
3. Open questions
4. Next meeting
If an owner or a date is not in the notes, write "Not stated."
Do not add anything that is not in the notes.

Notes:
FAQ draft is done. Priya found two errors; Jamie fixes them by Wednesday.
Team decided to launch the FAQ page next Monday. Marco will ask legal about
the pricing page. Next check-in Thursday.

Message AI...

CHECK THE ANSWER

Expected result

Case: Start a **new chat**, copy and send the template with the Week 2 notes in place of {Meeting_Notes}.

Decisions: launch the FAQ page next Monday. Actions: fix two errors, Jamie, Wednesday; ask legal about the pricing page, Marco, **Not stated**. Open question: when will legal answer? Next meeting: Thursday.

Part B: Your turn (write it)

Fill in the template yourself and send it.

YOUR TASK

Write your own prompt

Week 3 notes: "FAQ page launched Monday. Customer emails about shipping went down. Someone should update the shipping page. Legal said the pricing page is fine; publish it next week. Next check-in Friday." Put these notes into the template yourself and send it in a new chat.

CHECK THE ANSWER

Expected result

Decisions: publish the pricing page next week. Actions: update the shipping page, **Not stated**, **Not stated**; publish the pricing page, **Not stated**, next week. Open questions: who updates the shipping page, and who publishes the pricing page? Next meeting: Friday. "Customer emails about shipping went down" is a fact, not a decision or an action.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W13_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- **Introduction:** Explain Rina's root problem (30 minutes a week and lost tasks), her idea to let AI write the recap, and what went wrong with the first summary.
- **Method:** Copy Poor Prompt 1, Improved Prompts 1 and 2, and the saved template. For Part A and Part B, show only the notes you placed into the template.
- **Results:** Include the errors in the Poor Prompt 1 summary, the Week 1 recap, and the Week 2 and Week 3 recaps, each checked against the notes.
- **Conclusion:** Recommend whether Rina's team should use the template every week, in one or two sentences. Name one fact that supports it and one check a person must still do.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- You can explain in one sentence why "Priya will handle the legal review" was a dangerous error, and your Part B recap shows "Not stated" for both missing owners.